



Managing a Team

As your new business grows, your focus may change from working directly on tasks yourself, to team management. Setting clear, SMART goals and establishing shared core values will help your team thrive.

Investing in your team

Employing staff can be a major expense for your new business, so it is vital that you make the most of your team. Employees are likely to be more motivated if they are well managed, have clear goals, and are rewarded for successes. Even a small business needs a sense of shared values and culture. When you and your colleagues establish a positive work culture and

shared core values (see pp.162–163), it can make your business a satisfying place to work. Set a good example by arriving early and being positive and polite, even under pressure. Consistency is a quality employees value.

People work best when they know what is going on, so set clear objectives for your team and ensure information is shared freely around the business.

SMART management

The SMART approach enables you to set and achieve clear objectives for your team. Each objective is measured against five criteria: it must be specific, measurable, achievable, realistic, and time-based. This ensures that you and your colleagues approach tasks in a consistent way.

S—Specific

Set precise goals using specific figures or quantities. Make sure to establish an exact target—an increase of 50 percent in productivity, for example—so your team knows precisely what they need to achieve.

M—Measurable

Ensure that you can quantify your objective. Establish a measurement system to record progress made toward your goal. This enables you to assess the success of the task once it is completed.

